

RISK PERCEPTION

Climate change



1. Introduction: Climate Change and the Concept of Risk

Climate change is not only an environmental issue but also a global crisis with economic, social, and psychological dimensions. Rising global temperatures, extreme weather events, droughts, and sea level rise have led people to perceive climate change as a significant **risk**. Risk perception refers to how individuals or societies evaluate potential threats and how they respond to them. In the context of climate change, risk perception plays a critical role in shaping policies, behaviors, and preventive actions.

2. Factors Affecting Risk Perception in Climate Change

Risk perception related to climate change varies from person to person and from society to society. Key factors influencing this perception include education level, age, socioeconomic status, cultural values, and personal experiences. For instance, individuals who have directly experienced climate-related disasters such as floods, wildfires, or droughts tend to have a higher risk perception. Additionally, media coverage, social media content, and statements from scientists significantly shape how people perceive climate-related risks.

3. Individual and Societal Risk Perception

Individual risk perception focuses on how much people believe climate change will affect their own lives, while societal risk perception considers its impact on society as a whole. Some individuals see climate change as a distant future problem, whereas others view it as an urgent and immediate threat. A low level of societal risk perception can delay preventive actions and the adoption of sustainable behaviors. Therefore, raising public awareness is essential.

4. Effects of Risk Perception on Behavior

Risk perception regarding climate change directly influences individuals' daily habits and environmental behaviors. People with a high level of risk perception are more likely to save energy, prioritize recycling, and choose environmentally friendly products. In contrast, when risk perception is low, indifference toward environmental issues may increase. This reduces individual contribution to combating climate change and weakens collective efforts.

5. Conclusion and Evaluation

Risk perception arising from climate change is a key factor in addressing this global challenge. Through accurate scientific information, education, and effective communication strategies, risk perception can be strengthened. As a result, it becomes possible to develop more conscious and responsible behaviors at both individual and societal levels. In the fight against climate change, not only technological solutions but also how people perceive risk will be decisive.